

PRISM ISM Database

FDI Screening Mechanism Data Platform

User Manual

Version 1.0 | Data range: 2007–2023

<https://jonebroom.github.io/prism-fdi/>

38 Countries · 17 Years · 6 Analytical Views

OECD · EU/EEA · Five Eyes · 650 time-series records · 143 regulations · 141
policy documents

This manual covers all platform features, data fields, and analytical modules.
Intended for lawyers, investment professionals, compliance teams, and researchers.

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1 Platform Overview

PRISM (Policy Review and Investment Screening Mechanisms) is an interactive data platform that provides comprehensive, time-series coverage of foreign direct investment (FDI) screening mechanisms across 38 countries from 2007 to 2023.

1.1 What is FDI Screening?

Foreign direct investment screening refers to government processes that review—and potentially block or impose conditions on—inbound foreign investments on grounds of national security, public order, or strategic economic interests. Since the mid-2010s, the number of countries operating formal screening mechanisms has grown rapidly, driven by geopolitical tensions, the COVID-19 pandemic, and the EU FDI Screening Regulation of 2019.

1.2 Who is this platform for?

- **Legal practitioners and compliance teams** — quickly assess whether a proposed transaction triggers mandatory filing in a target jurisdiction.
- **Investment professionals** — compare screening regimes across potential target markets and understand deal timeline risks.
- **Policy researchers and academics** — trace the diffusion and tightening of FDI screening norms over time.
- **Government officials** — benchmark national mechanisms against peer countries.

1.3 Data Scope

Dimension	Coverage
Countries	38 (OECD members, EU/EEA states, Five Eyes)
Time range	2007–2023 (annual observations)
Records	650 country-year time-series entries
Regulations	143 individual regulatory instruments
Legislative events	230 legislative change events
Policy documents	141 full-text source documents (PDF + HTML)
Sectors tracked	36 detailed + 8 aggregate categories
Procedural indicators	13 binary powers + 4 quantitative fields

Table 1: PRISM data coverage summary

Data currency

All data reflect published information as of late 2023. The 2024 year is intentionally excluded as coverage was incomplete. The platform uses the most recent complete year (2023) as the default view.

1.4 Country Groups

Countries are organised into three overlapping groups used throughout the platform for filtering and colour-coding:

- **OECD** — Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development members
- **EU/EEA** — European Union and European Economic Area members
- **Five Eyes** — Australia, Canada, New Zealand, United Kingdom, United States

Countries may belong to more than one group (e.g. Australia is both OECD and Five Eyes).

2 Interface Layout

The PRISM interface is divided into four persistent areas that are always visible, plus drawers that slide in on demand.

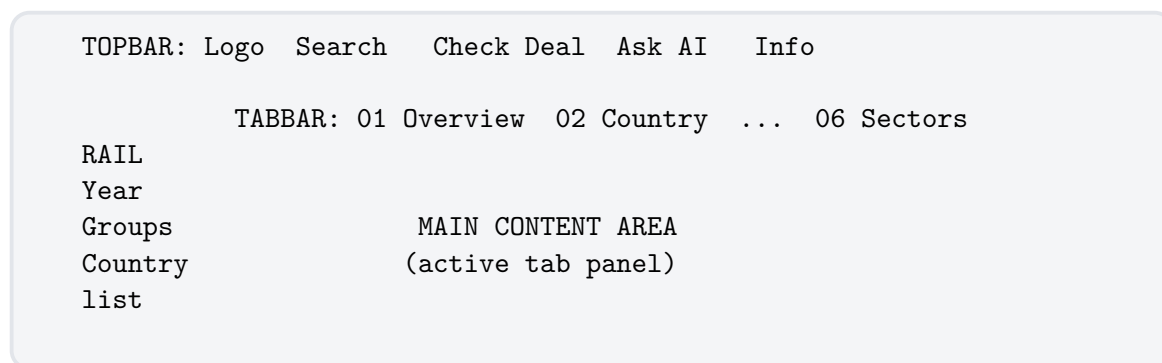


Figure 1: PRISM interface layout schematic

2.1 Top Bar

The top bar spans the full width and contains:

- *PRISM logo* — platform identity; subtitle shows country count and year range.

- *Global Search box* — full-text search across countries, regulations, and policy documents. Press [/] anywhere to focus it.
- *Check Deal* — opens the Deal Screener drawer (see Section 9).
- *Ask AI* — opens the AI Data Assistant drawer (see Section 10).
- — opens the Platform Guide drawer with quick reference information.

2.2 Control Rail (Sidebar)

The left sidebar contains all global controls that affect the entire platform:

2.2.1 Year Selector

- The large year number shows the currently selected year.
- Drag the *slider* left or right to move between 2007 and 2023.
- Click *Play Timeline* to animate through all years automatically (one year per second). Click *Pause* to stop. Switching to another tab also stops the animation.

2.2.2 Country Group Filters

Three toggle buttons filter which countries appear in all charts and lists:

-  (19 countries) — click to include/exclude.
-  (27 countries) — click to include/exclude.
-  (5 countries) — click to include/exclude.

Important

At least one group must remain active. If you deactivate all three the last toggle is automatically re-enabled. Country overlap between groups means total active countries may be fewer than the sum of group sizes.

2.2.3 Country List

Displays all countries passing the current group filter. Each row shows:

- A coloured dot indicating group membership.
- Country name.

- Year the screening mechanism was established (or "—" if none).

Use the *Filter countries...* search box above the list for quick lookup. Clicking any country selects it, highlights it in the list, and automatically switches to the **Country** tab to show that country's profile.

2.3 Tab Bar

Six analytical tabs are available. Each tab is independent but responds to the global year and country selection set in the rail.

No.	Tab name	Purpose
01	Overview	World map + global trend line + annual snapshot
02	Country	In-depth profile for the selected country
03	Comparison	Multi-country parallel coordinates
04	Evolution	Coverage type trends, strictness distribution, network
05	Changes	Global legislative activity by year
06	Sectors	Industry coverage heatmap and ranking

Table 2: The six analytical tabs

2.4 Mobile Usage

On screens narrower than 768 px (smartphones and small tablets):

- The sidebar is hidden by default. Tap in the top-left corner to open it.
- Tap outside the sidebar (on the dark overlay) or the button to close it.
- Selecting a country automatically closes the sidebar.
- The tab bar becomes horizontally scrollable.
- All chart panels stack vertically.

2.5 Keyboard Shortcuts

Key	Action
[/]	Focus the global search box
[Esc]	Close any open drawer
[Enter] (in search)	Navigate to first result
[↑]/[↓] (in search)	Move through results

Table 3: Keyboard shortcuts

3 Tab 01 — Overview

The Overview tab is the landing view and provides a global snapshot of FDI screening activity for the selected year.

3.1 World Map

- Each country with data is shaded according to the selected *dimension* (chosen from the dropdown in the panel header).
- Darker shading indicates a higher value. Countries not in the active group filter are shown in light grey.
- **Available map dimensions:**
 - **Strictness Score (0-13)** — sum of all 13 procedural powers.
 - **Sectors Covered** — number of sectors under the screening mechanism.
 - **Review Threshold (%)** — minimum equity stake triggering a review.
 - **Review Timeframe (days)** — maximum statutory review period.
- **Click** any country on the map to open a dark floating card showing key indicators. Click *View Details* → to jump to that country's full profile.
- The map supports **zoom and pan**: scroll to zoom, drag to pan. Double-click resets the view.

3.2 Global Trend Chart

The line chart on the left of the lower row tracks how many countries have a selected feature active each year, overlaid with a bar chart of new mechanisms established globally per year.

- Use the *dropdown* to change the tracked feature (e.g. National Security Test, Fines, Mitigation powers).
- Two vertical dashed lines mark **2019** (EU FDI Regulation impetus, blue) and **2020** (COVID-19 emergency legislation wave, orange).
- **Click** any year on the chart to jump the global year slider to that year.

3.3 Annual Snapshot Panel

The right panel shows a summary for the currently active country set in the selected year:

- **Countries with mechanism** — how many of the filtered countries have an active screening regime.
- **Average Strictness** — mean strictness score across all countries with mechanisms.
- **Average Sectors Covered** — mean sector count.
- **New Mechanisms This Year** — globally, how many new mechanisms were established.
- **Coverage Type Distribution** — horizontal bar chart showing how many countries fall into each coverage model (Sectoral, Cross-sectoral, Mixed, Asset-based, etc.).

4 Tab 02 — Country

The Country tab provides the most detailed view of a single country's FDI screening mechanism. Select a country from the sidebar list or by clicking the world map.

4.1 Practitioner Summary Card

The top card is designed for quick practical reference:

4.1.1 Status Badge

A coloured badge in the top-right corner summarises the overall risk level:

Badge	Colour	Meaning
No mechanism	Grey	No active screening mechanism in the selected year
Screening exists	Green	Mechanism exists but strictness score is low (0–3)
Active screening	Amber	Moderate strictness (4–7)
Strict screening	Red-orange	High strictness (8–13)

Table 4: Country status badge definitions

4.1.2 Filing Requirement Block

Shows the practical answer to "do I need to file?":

- **Pre-approval required before closing** — mandatory pre-approval; the transaction cannot close without government sign-off.
- **Notification mandatory** — filing is required but the transaction may proceed before a decision.
- **No mandatory filing** — voluntary notification only, or no mechanism.
- **Threshold** — the minimum equity stake (%) that triggers the review obligation.
- **Max review time** — the statutory maximum review period in days.
- **Notification** — the specific notification regime text from the source data.

4.1.3 Review Authority Block

- **Lead authority** — the government agency that administers screening.
- **Review criteria** — the legal grounds on which investments may be blocked (national security, net economic benefit, competition, dual-use/export control).
- **Strictness score** — the count of all active procedural powers out of 13.
- **Sectors in scope** — the number of sectors covered.

4.1.4 Scope & Powers Block

- Whether greenfield investments (new establishments, not just acquisitions) are covered.
- Whether real estate transactions are covered.
- Whether the mechanism distinguishes between EU and non-EU investors.
- Feature pills listing active powers: Formal call-in, Interagency review, Tiered authority, Mitigation powers, Fines/penalties, Golden share, EU vs. non-EU distinction.

4.1.5 Quick Deal Check Button

The *Check a specific deal for this country* button at the bottom of the card pre-fills the Deal Screener with the currently selected country and opens it immediately.

4.2 Multi-Dimensional Radar Chart

Plots the selected country on 8 procedural dimensions simultaneously, with two reference lines:

- **Red-orange line** — selected country in the current year.
- **Grey dashed line** — OECD average for the current year.
- **Blue dotted line** — selected country in a historical comparison year (choose from the *Compare [year]* dropdown).

Radar dimensions: NS Test, Formal Call-in, Fines, Mitigation, Interagency Review, Net Benefit Test, Enhanced Gov. Control, Ownership Review.

How to use the radar

Switch the comparison year to a specific year (e.g. 2015) to see how much a country's mechanism has tightened over time. Use the global year slider to examine a particular period.

4.3 Key Indicators Panel

A structured list of all available data fields for the selected country and year, including: Lead Authority, Coverage Type, Notification regime, Pre-approval regime, Review Threshold, Review Timeframe, EU vs. non-EU difference, COVID-19 temporary legislation flag.

4.4 Procedural Requirements & Coverage

A grid of 16 binary indicators grouped into four categories:

Group	Indicators
Investigation & Review Powers	Formal Call-in, Increased Ownership Review, Interagency Review, Tiered Authority, Enhanced Gov. Control
Tests & Standards	National Security Test, Net Benefit Test, Competition Test
Sanctions & Mechanisms	Fines, Mitigation, Filing Fees, Local Representation, Co-location
Coverage Scope	Greenfield, Real Estate, Export Control/Dual-Use

Table 5: Procedural indicators grouped by category

Each indicator is displayed as (present) or (absent).

4.5 Regulation Timeline

A horizontal bubble timeline showing every regulatory instrument recorded for the selected country:

- Each bubble's **size** is proportional to the number of sectors covered by that regulation.
- Each bubble's **colour** reflects the coverage type.
- **Click** any bubble to open a detail drawer with:
 - Full regulation name, year signed / year effective.
 - Lead authority, notification regime, threshold, timeframe.
 - Sectors covered count.
 - Supersession information (if this regulation replaced an earlier one).
 - Policy text excerpt (if a source document is available).
 - *Summarize with AI* → button to send the regulation to the AI assistant.
 - ↴ *Download PDF* or *View Source* link to the original document.

5 Tab 03 — Comparison

The Comparison tab uses a **parallel coordinates** chart to visualise all active countries simultaneously across multiple dimensions.

5.1 Reading the Chart

- Each **vertical axis** represents one indicator.
- Each **coloured line** represents one country in the selected year.
- Where a line sits on each axis indicates that country's value for that indicator.
- Countries with no mechanism are excluded.

Axes displayed: Mechanisms count, Strictness score, Sectors covered, Threshold %, Timeframe (days), Fines (Yes/No), Mitigation (Yes/No), Interagency review (Yes/No), National Security Test (Yes/No), Net Benefit Test (Yes/No).

5.2 Interactions

- **Drag along any axis** to create a filter range; only lines that pass through the selection remain highlighted, making it easy to find, for example, all countries with a threshold below 25% and an active NS test.
- **Hover** over a line to highlight it and see a tooltip with all values.
- **Click** a line to jump to that country's full profile in the Country tab.
- Use the *Color by group* / *Color by strictness* toggle to switch between group-based and strictness-gradient colouring.

Typical use case

Select a target country and drag the Strictness axis to its value. The remaining highlighted countries have similar strictness levels — useful for peer comparison or identifying jurisdictions with comparable compliance burdens.

6 Tab 04 — Evolution

The Evolution tab contains five charts that together illustrate how FDI screening regimes have changed structurally over time.

6.1 Coverage Type Distribution (Pie Chart)

A pie chart for the currently selected year showing how many countries fall into each coverage model:

- **Sectoral** — only specific industries are covered.
- **Cross-sectoral** — all sectors are potentially in scope.
- **Mixed** — a combination of broad and sector-specific rules.
- **Asset-based** — screening is triggered by asset type, not sector.
- **Draft** — legislation has been proposed but not yet enacted.
- **Passed (not impl.)** — law passed but implementing regulations not yet in force.

Click any segment to open a drawer listing all countries of that type in the selected year.

6.2 Notification × Pre-approval Matrix (Bubble Chart)

A 3×3 matrix plotting countries on two axes:

- **X-axis (Notification):** Not mandatory · Mandatory (some transactions) · Mandatory (all transactions)
- **Y-axis (Pre-approval):** Not mandatory · Mandatory (some) · Mandatory (all)
- **Bubble size:** Number of countries at that combination.

Click any bubble to see the list of countries with that combination of procedural requirements.

6.3 Coverage Type Evolution (Area Chart)

A stacked area chart showing, for each year from 2007 to 2023, how many countries operate each coverage model. Read this chart to observe the structural shift from Sectoral to Cross-sectoral mechanisms that accelerated after 2019.

6.4 Strictness Distribution Over Time (Ridge/Band Chart)

Plots the **mean strictness score** per year as a line, surrounded by a band showing the **minimum and maximum** values. The widening band reflects growing divergence between the strictest and most lenient jurisdictions.

6.5 Threshold vs. Strictness / Timeframe vs. Strictness (Scatter Chart)

A scatter plot for the selected year with:

- **X-axis** — Review threshold (%) or Review timeframe (days), switchable via the *Threshold/Timeframe* toggle.
- **Y-axis** — Strictness score (0–13).
- Each point is a country. **Click** to go to that country's profile.

Countries in the top-left (high strictness, low threshold / short timeframe) impose the most demanding practical burden on investors.

6.6 Regulation Supersession Network

A directed network graph where:

- **Nodes** are individual regulations, coloured by country group.
- **Directed edges** point from an old law to the new law that superseded it.
- Clusters of nodes connected by edges represent a country's legislative lineage.
- **Click** any node to navigate to that country's profile.

7 Tab 05 — Changes

The Changes tab focuses on legislative activity — what happened, and when.

7.1 Global Legislative Activity Bar Chart

A stacked bar chart showing, for each year, how many legislative events occurred globally, broken down by type:

- **New Law** — an entirely new statute creating a screening mechanism.
- **Amendment** — modifications to an existing law.
- **Exec. Order** — presidential/executive orders or emergency decrees.
- **Reg. Impl.** — implementing regulations under a previously enacted law.

Click any bar to select that year; the event list below updates to show all events for that year, and the **global year slider synchronises** to the clicked year — so switching to the Country or Overview tab will show data for that year.

7.2 Legislative Events List

Each event card shows:

- Year and country.
- Law name or reference (bare reference numbers like 34/2020 are labelled as "Reference:" to indicate the full name was not available in source data).
- Brief explanation of what changed (if available).

- Event type chip(s): New Law, Amendment, Exec. Order, or Implementation.
- A "Supersedes" chip if this legislation replaced an earlier instrument.

Click any event card to open a detail drawer with:

- Matched mechanism data (lead authority, threshold, strictness, sectors) if a corresponding regulation record can be found.
- Policy text excerpt with the full regulation text (if available).
- *View [Country] details* → button to go to the Country tab.
- *Summarize with AI* → to ask the AI assistant about the regulation.

8 Tab 06 — Sectors

The Sectors tab analyses which industries are covered by FDI screening across countries and over time.

8.1 Sector Coverage Heatmap

A matrix with:

- **Rows** — individual sectors (or 8 aggregate categories, switchable).
- **Columns** — countries, sorted by total sector coverage (most covered first).
- **Cell colour** — dark = sector is covered; light = not covered.

Two display modes:

- *Detailed Sectors* — shows all 36 individual sector names (e.g. “Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning”, “Civil Nuclear”, “Quantum Technology”).
- *8 Aggregate Categories* — shows coverage as a percentage (0–100%) for each of the eight broad categories, with gradient colour.

8.2 Sector Coverage Ranking (Bar Chart)

A horizontal bar chart ranking all sectors by the number of countries that include them in their screening mechanism. Sectors covered by more countries appear at the top.

- The chart reflects the currently selected year.
- Click *Play* to animate through all years, watching the ranking evolve as new sectors are added to national mechanisms. Click *Pause* to stop.
- Switching to a different tab automatically stops the animation.

The 8 aggregate sector categories are:

Category	Typical sub-sectors
Defense	Defense production, controlled dual-use, export control
Physical Critical Infrastructure	Energy, water, transport, healthcare, telecom
Next-Gen Critical Infrastructure	Space, advanced computing, quantum, AI
Critical Tech & Dual-Use	Cybersecurity, robotics, biotechnology, advanced materials
Non-tradeable Services	Gambling, tourism, education, civil nuclear
Finance	Banking, insurance, payments
Media	Broadcasting, news, publishing
Sensitive Personal Data	Access to personal data, brain-computer interfaces

Table 6: The 8 aggregate sector categories

9 Deal Screener

The Deal Screener answers the practical question: “**Is this transaction likely to require filing?**”

How to open

Click *Check Deal* in the top bar, or click *Check a specific deal* on any country’s profile card.

9.1 Input Fields

1. **Target Country** — the country in which the investment target is located.
2. **Sector / Industry** — choose from 8 broad categories or 36 detailed sectors. Leave blank if unsure.
3. **Proposed Acquisition Stake (%)** — the equity percentage the investor intends to acquire. Leave blank if unknown.

4. **Your Country** — the investor’s home country, used to determine EU/EEA status where the mechanism distinguishes between EU and non-EU investors.

9.2 Verdict

After clicking *Check this deal* →, the screener returns one of five verdict levels:

Verdict	Colour	Meaning
Review likely required	Red-orange	Sector covered, stake above threshold, mandatory pre-approval
Review may apply	Amber	Some factors suggest filing, but certainty is limited
Below threshold	Green	Stake appears below the recorded threshold
Sector out of scope	Green	Selected sector not covered by the mechanism
No mechanism	Grey	No active formal mechanism in the selected year

Table 7: Deal Screener verdict levels

The verdict is accompanied by a plain-language explanation covering: coverage scope, threshold comparison, filing obligation, EU/non-EU distinction (if applicable), maximum review period, and lead authority.

A *View full [Country] profile* → button allows immediate navigation to the Country tab for deeper review.

Legal disclaimer

The Deal Screener provides an indicative assessment based on publicly available data in the PRISM database. It does not constitute legal advice. Always consult the relevant national authority or qualified legal counsel before proceeding with a transaction.

10 AI Data Assistant

The AI Assistant allows natural-language questions about the PRISM data.

How to open

Click *Ask AI* in the top bar.

10.1 Capabilities

The assistant is context-aware: it knows the currently selected year, country, active group filter, and tab. It can:

- Compare mechanisms across countries (“How does Germany’s screening compare to France’s in 2022?”).
- Identify trends (“Which countries tightened their mechanisms most after 2019?”).
- Explain data fields (“What does the Net Benefit Test mean?”).
- List countries with specific features (“Which countries cover the AI sector in 2023?”).
- Summarise individual regulations (via the *Summarize with AI* → button in any policy document drawer).

10.2 Quick Prompts (Chips)

The assistant pre-generates 3–4 context-relevant prompt suggestions based on the current tab and selected country. Click any chip to send it immediately.

10.3 Configuration

Click the  icon to configure the AI backend:

- **Provider** — Anthropic (Claude), OpenAI, DeepSeek, MiniMax, Zhipu GLM, Moonshot Kimi, or any custom OpenAI-compatible endpoint.
- **Model** — pre-populated with recommended models per provider; can be overridden manually.
- **Base URL** — required only for custom providers.
- **API Key** — stored in browser local storage; never transmitted anywhere except directly to the selected provider’s API endpoint.

Keyboard shortcut

Press [Enter] to send a message. Use [Shift+Enter] for a line break within the input box.

10.4 Limitations

- The assistant’s answers are based on the data context injected at query time, not real-time web access.
- For quantitative questions, the assistant receives the top-8 strictness ranking, the selected country’s full profile, and any sector coverage lists mentioned in the query.
- Responses are capped at approximately 250 words (longer for comparison lists).
- The quality of answers depends on the selected AI provider and model.

11 Global Search

The search box in the top bar supports three search modes:

Mode	What it searches
Countries	Country names; clicking a result selects that country and opens the Country tab
Regulations	Regulation titles and country names from the events database
Policy text	Full-text search across all 141 policy documents; matching passages are highlighted

Table 8: Search modes

- Use the *Countries* / *Regulations* / *Policy* toggle at the top of the results panel to switch modes.
- Policy text results open a detail drawer with the matched excerpt highlighted in amber and a link to download or view the original document.
- Press [↑]/[↓] to navigate results, [Enter] to select, [Esc] to close.

12 URL Sharing

PRISM automatically keeps the browser URL in sync with the current state:

<https://jonebroom.github.io/prism-fdi/?tab=country&country=Germany&year=2021>

- `tab` — the active tab name.

- **country** — the selected country (exact English name as used in the data).
- **year** — the selected year.

Copy the URL from the browser address bar at any time to create a shareable link that will restore the exact same view for another user.

13 Data Fields Reference

13.1 Quantitative Fields

Field	Type	Definition
<code>num_mechanisms</code>	Integer	Number of distinct screening instruments active
<code>strictness</code>	0–13	Sum of all 13 binary procedural indicators
<code>threshold</code>	% (0–100)	Minimum equity acquisition % triggering review
<code>time_frame_days</code>	Days	Statutory maximum review period
<code>total_sectors</code>	Integer	Number of sectors explicitly covered

Table 9: Quantitative data fields

13.2 The 13 Procedural Power Indicators

Each is a binary (0/1) variable coded from official legislation and regulatory guidance:

13.3 Coverage Type Classification

13.4 Notification and Pre-approval Regimes

Both fields use the same vocabulary:

- **Not mandatory** — no formal filing obligation; voluntary submission only.
- **Mandatory (some)** — filing required for transactions meeting specific criteria (sector, threshold, or investor origin).
- **Mandatory (all)** — filing required for all foreign investments above a de minimis level.

14 Frequently Asked Questions

Indicator	Meaning
Formal Call-in	Authority can initiate a review on its own motion, without a filing
Increased Ownership Review	Subsequent increases in stake above threshold also require review
Filing Fees	Mandatory fees are charged on filing
Mitigation	Authority can impose conditions (remedies) short of full prohibition
Fines	Monetary penalties can be imposed for non-compliance or violations
National Security Test	Explicit national security standard in the review criteria
Net Benefit Test	Economic benefit to the host country is a review criterion
Competition Test	Effects on market competition are a review criterion
Interagency Review	Multiple government agencies participate in the review
Tiered Authority	Different authorities have jurisdiction depending on sector or deal size
Local Representation	Acquirer must appoint a local representative or board member
Enhanced Gov. Control	Government retains a special share or veto right post-approval
Co-location	Physical infrastructure must be co-located in the host country

Table 10: The 13 procedural power indicators

Q1. Why does a country appear on the map but show “No mechanism” in the Country tab?

The map shows all 38 countries. A country will show no mechanism if: (a) the selected year predates when its mechanism was established, or (b) the country has never established a formal screening regime.

Q2. The threshold field shows "—". What does that mean?

Either the country’s mechanism applies to all foreign investments without a specific equity threshold, the threshold is defined in subsidiary regulations not captured at this level of detail, or the information was not available in public sources.

Q3. Why are some regulation names shown as "Reference: 34/2020" instead of a full title?

Some source datasets recorded only the legal reference number (e.g. an act

Type	Definition
Sectoral	Review is limited to investments in explicitly listed sectors
Cross-sectoral	All sectors potentially subject to review; broadest scope
Mixed	Combines mandatory sectoral rules with discretionary broader review
Asset-based	Triggered by the nature of the asset (e.g. critical infrastructure) rather than the sector
Draft	Legislation introduced but not yet enacted
Passed (not implemented)	Law enacted; implementing regulations or effective date not yet in force

Table 11: Coverage type classification

number and year) without the full title. These are flagged automatically with the "Reference:" prefix to indicate the name is a bare citation, not a descriptive title.

Q4. How does the strictness score work?

Strictness is the simple sum of the 13 binary procedural power indicators. A country with all 13 powers active scores 13; a country with only an NS test and fines scores 2. It is a procedural complexity measure, not a measure of how often reviews result in prohibition.

Q5. Can I export the data?

The platform does not currently include a built-in export function. The underlying dataset is described in the platform's data notes. For research use, please contact the dataset creators.

Q6. The AI assistant says it cannot answer my question. Why?

The assistant only uses data available in PRISM. Questions requiring information outside the 38-country, 2007–2023 scope, or requiring real-time legal advice, will receive a disclaimer. Ensure your API key and provider are correctly configured.

Q7. Is the Deal Screener output legally reliable?

No. It provides an indicative, automated assessment based on coded data. FDI screening obligations depend on transaction-specific facts, regulatory interpretation, and guidance that changes frequently. Always verify with the relevant national authority and qualified legal counsel.

Q8. Why does the map show my country in grey even though the group filter includes it?

The grey shading indicates either: (a) the country has no mechanism in the selected year, or (b) the selected map dimension has no data for that country-year

(e.g. threshold data is missing). Hover over the country for a tooltip explaining what data is available.

Q9. The URL I shared opens in a different state than expected.

URL restoration requires the target country name to match exactly. Country names use standard English (e.g. “United States”, “Republic of Korea”). If the URL was created with a different year than the data range (2007–2023), the year will be clamped to the nearest valid value.

15 Data Sources and Methodology

15.1 Primary Data Source

The platform is built on the **PRISM ISM Dataset** (version 2023.12), a structured database of FDI screening mechanisms compiled from official government sources, legislative databases, and academic literature.

15.2 Coding Methodology

- Binary indicators are coded **1** if the feature is explicitly present in operative legislation and **0** otherwise. Ambiguous cases are coded 0 (conservative approach).
- Threshold values reflect the lowest applicable threshold where tiered thresholds exist.
- Timeframe values reflect the maximum statutory review period at the initial stage (not including possible extension periods).
- Coverage type reflects the primary operative mechanism where multiple instruments co-exist.

15.3 Known Limitations

- Sub-national and sector-specific lower thresholds may not be fully captured by the single threshold field.
- Emergency and temporary legislation (including COVID-19 measures) is flagged where identified but may be inconsistently recorded across jurisdictions.
- A small number of historical records (pre-2007) are included for countries with long legislative lineages (e.g. Finland 1939) but are not part of the main analytical time series.

- Policy document full texts are sourced from publicly available HTML and PDF versions; formatting artefacts from PDF extraction may appear in the text viewer.

16 Quick Reference Card

PRISM at a Glance

Open country profile	Click country in sidebar list, or click country on world map → View Details
Filter by group	Toggle OECD / EU/EEA / Five Eyes buttons in the rail
Change year	Drag the year slider, or click a year on any time-series chart
Animate over time	Click Play Timeline (stops on tab switch)
Check a deal	Check Deal → fill country, sector, stake, origin
Ask a question	Ask AI → type or click a chip prompt
Find a regulation	Press / → switch to Policy mode → search keywords
Share a view	Copy the URL from the address bar
View policy text	Click any regulation bubble or event card → policy text shown in drawer
Compare years	Country tab → radar chart → select "Compare [year]" dropdown

Data Field Quick Reference

Strictness (0–13)	Sum of 13 binary procedural powers. Higher = more complex mechanism.
Threshold (%)	Minimum equity stake triggering review (blank = applies to all / unknown).
Timeframe (days)	Maximum statutory review period at initial stage.
Coverage type	Sectoral → Cross-sectoral → Mixed → Asset-based (increasing scope).
Pre-approval	Must receive clearance <i>before</i> closing the transaction.
Notification	Must notify authorities (transaction may close before decision).

This manual was generated automatically from the platform source code and data schema.